

ALCHEMY AOE ALLIANCE

**TYPE:
HANDBOOK
(HDBK)**



**PROJECT:
N/A**

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REVISION: OI

Handbook, Alchemy League Season 8

Page 1 of 9

Table of Contents

1 - Referenced Documents.....	2	6 - League Format.....	5
2 - Background.....	2	7 - Tournament Elo.....	6
3 - Overview.....	3	8 - Custom Map Information.....	7
4 - Prize Money.....	3	9 - General Settings.....	8
5 - Timeline.....	4		

1 - Referenced Documents

Table 1 below is a list of all specifications that are components to this one. Each of its entries were designed as an interchangeable part, to be used in context for this specification, or others like it:

Specification Number	Nomenclature
<u>MTHD-002</u>	Calculation, Tournament Elo
<u>MTHD-003</u>	Elo Correction, Handicap
<u>MTHD-004</u>	Discipline, Pa2 Round Robin
<u>MTHD-005</u>	Winner Selection, Round Robin
<u>MTHD-006</u>	Earnings, Round Robin
<u>MTHD-007</u>	Structure, Single Division Stack League
<u>STND-005</u>	Competition, General Rules
<u>PSRM-002</u>	Player's Choice, Returning Maps
<u>PSRM-003</u>	Selected Maps, ALS8

Table 1: Bill of Materials

If any part of any documents listed in Table 1 conflict with this specification, then this specification shall assume priority.

2 - Background

The *Alchemy Alliance (ALAL)* is a free and non-profit organization of random map scripters, tournament hosts, content creators, and skilled players dedicated to the advancement of custom random maps in Age of Empires II: Definitive Edition. As the nucleus of the *Alchemy AOE Community*, the *ALAL* publishes quality standards for custom random maps, and curates the finished products to be featured into thematic competitions where adventuresome players may exhibit creative strategies for maximum entertainment value.



3 - Overview

This handbook describes Alchemy League, an Age of Empires II 1v1 competition hosted by the *Alchemy Alliance* with the following unique features, summarized in reference below:

- Participants will generally not face an opponent 300 elo higher than they are without handicap.
- Cutting-edge tournament elo calculation from online match history, based on weighted average and refactored to account for win rate.
- Handicap used sparingly to include extremities of bell curve, so that no player will be turned away based on skill.
- Unique bracketing structure & prize distribution.
- Standard Victory Condition on a Custom Map Pool.

4 - Prize Money

Prize Money Details per Table 4 below

Title	Amount	Details
Winners per Sprint	8	Top Performers per <u>MTHD-005</u>
Prizes, Players of Sprint 1	\$80 USD	Distribution per <u>MTHD-006</u>
Prizes, Players of Sprint 2	\$160 USD	
Skill Bias Exponent	1.25	
Prizes, Map Creators	\$120 USD	Distribution per <u>PSRM-PC-1</u>
Payment Platform	~	<u>Paypal</u>
Country of Payment Origin	~	United States of America

Table 4: Prize Money Information



5 - Timeline

Start Date (YY-MM-DD)	End Date (YY-MM-DD)	Milestone(s):
~	2025-07-13	Specification Package Released
2025-07-14	2025-07-21	Map Nominations Open
2025-07-22	2025-07-25	Map Nomination Check Phase
2025-07-26	2025-08-02	Map Feedback Phase
2025-08-03	2025-08-17	Map Update Phase
2025-08-18	2025-08-22	Map Inspection Phase
2025-08-23	2025-08-25	Map Slideshow Preparation
2025-08-26	2025-09-09	Map Voting Phase
~	2025-09-11	Release <u>PSRM-003</u>
~	2025-09-14	Registrations Close
2025-09-17	2025-09-30	Round 1 (Sprint 1)
2025-09-24	2025-10-07	Round 2 (Sprint 1)
2025-10-01	2025-10-14	Round 3 (Sprint 1)
2025-10-08	2025-10-21	Round 4 (Sprint 1)
2025-10-22	2025-10-28	Break, Calculate Winnings
2025-10-29	2025-11-11	Round 5 (Sprint 2)
2025-11-05	2025-11-18	Round 6 (Sprint 2)
2025-11-12	2025-11-25	Round 7 (Sprint 2)
2025-11-19	2025-12-02	Round 8 (Sprint 2)
2025-12-03	2025-12-09	End, Calculate Winnings

Table 5: Timeline, Alchemy League, This Season



6 - League Format

Title	Min	Max	Details
Team Size	~	~	1v1
Number of Divisions	1	1	Round Robin per <u>MTHD-007</u> .
Number of Sprints	2	2	
Rounds per Sprint	4	4	
Games per Round	2	3	After completing the minimum number of required games, players may mutually agree to continue playing until the maximum number of games has been reached, regardless of results from previous games. Submission of a recorded game file is the only accepted evidence of consent. All games played in this format will be used to calculate league results and payout.

Table 6: League Format Information



7 - Tournament Elo

Title	Details
Data Collection, Step 1	Reference internet APIs to garner all alternate or “smurf” accounts corresponding to the same player, derived through IP address, Steam account sharing, and other methods.
Data Collection, Step 2	Reference internet APIs to harvest all relevant match history corresponding to each of the accounts gathered from the previous step.
Tournament Elo, Formula	Calculated from 100 most recent games, linearly weighted per <u>MTHD-002</u> .
Tournament Elo, Confidence Window	Perform a tolerance sweep on win rate and elo fluctuation over history to estimate a range of possible tournament elos for each participant, with 100% confidence interval.
Tournament Elo, Final Value	Take tournament elo as the $\frac{3}{4}$ point going from minimum to maximum within confidence window.
Handicap	For each matched set of players, 100 shall be added to the lower of two elos and then <u>MTHD-003</u> applied to determine corrective handicap.

Table 7: Tournament Elo Information



8 - Custom Map Information

Title	Details
Map Qualities	“Player Choice Returning Maps” selected through process of <u>PSRM-002</u> . Resulting map pool defined in <u>PSRM-003</u> .
Featured Map	For each non-wild round, the tournament host will declare a map from the pool to be “Map of the Round”. A map cannot be “Map of the Round” twice in the same season of the league.
Obtaining Maps	To protect creator intellectual property rights, the Alchemy AOE Community does not upload competition resources to the in-game mod center. Participants shall download and execute the following batch script to automatically gain access to latest Alchemy League maps in game: <u>Download .bat file here</u>. The Alchemy AOE Community server is webhook-configured to notify players of any changes to the random map Github repository –the source of the custom map pool. Players are responsible for making sure they are using the latest versions by re-running the batch script whenever a relevant map is changed. Note that the batch script works only for Windows users. If a participant has a different operating system, tournament staff will assist as needed.
Map Selection, Round Wild	For the Round Wild, both players declare a home map. Then, they take turns discarding the remaining maps. If a third game is played, it shall be on the map discarded last.
Map Selection, Rounds Normal	The first map is the “Map of the Round”. Then, players take turns discarding the remaining maps until only two remain. The second game is played on a map randomly selected from the remainder. The unchosen map shall be used for a third game, if played. Draft Link provided in Tournament Server.

Table 8: Custom Map Information



9 - General Settings

Title	Details
Civilization Selection	Civilization Draft consists of five administrative bans, followed by 2 bans each, then 4 picks each, then one snipe each (hidden and parallel), and ends with a pick each.
Tournament Server	https://discord.gg/h9DvzHBNPr
Tournament Host	TechChariot
General Rules	Per <u>STND-005</u> .
Discipline	Administrative penalties assigned per <u>MTHD-004</u> .
First Sprint Eligibility	Participants shall have 100 1v1 games minimum and win rate between 15% and 85% totaled across all accounts.
Other Sprint Eligibility	Participants shall complete all previous Sprints without accumulation of excessive administrative penalties.
First Sprint Registration, Access Link	https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSfhK2aKf_JDuexuSibfBlqUvwG6RRAgC171BdIu9tVs3bvj2Q/viewform?usp=sharing
First Sprint All Signups, Access Link	https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1EICIfO41B5PudTbgvwgBbc4u1sjhVu6il4vDXiX9Ses/edit?resourcekey=&gid=1866421962#gid=1866421962
Other Sprint Registration	Current eligible players auto-enrolled in subsequent Sprints unless otherwise indicated at least 24 hours before start.

Table 9: General Settings



Signatures:

TechChariot

2025-03-29

*Prepared**Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*CookiePirate

2025-07-12

*Checked**Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*Honeybadger

2025-07-12

*Approved**Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*

Revision History:

<u>Revision</u>	Description	Change Document	Date (YYYY-MM-DD)
X1	-- Advanced Release for Community Review --	N/A	2025-05-15
X2	Added complete and accurate timetable, including map development period.	N/A	2025-05-19
OI	---- Original Issue ----	N/A	2025-07-12

